CASE STUDY · ANNUAL FUND CALLING

Special Olympics Indiana: an 85% pledge rate with lapsed donors.

Business donors who had not had a phone conversation in three to five years were re-engaged through AF Connect, at nearly double the industry pledge rate.



KEY RESULTS

85%
PLEDGE RATE WITH LAPSED DONORS

45%
INDUSTRY AVERAGE PLEDGE RATE

39%
INCREASE IN AVERAGE GIFT SIZE

3-5 YRS
SINCE LAST PHONE SOLICITATION

> *"What sets them apart is how collaborative they are. They involved me directly in training their team and took time to understand our vision and events. Having worked with two other vendors offering similar services, I can say without hesitation that Catapult is by far the best telefunding partner we've had."*
>
> Kelly Ries, Senior Director of Donor Engagement,
> Special Olympics Indiana

The Situation

Special Olympics Indiana wanted to renew and upgrade current and lapsed business donors, many not solicited by phone in three to five years, while freeing development staff to focus on major gifts. The program was outsourced to Catapult's dedicated team of professional callers.

The Process

Catapult's methodology is modeled on face-to-face solicitation. Each prospect received a pre-call letter signed by a volunteer, carrying that signer's personal reason for supporting, the case for support, and a personalized ask amount set from five years of giving history. Callers followed up to thank the donor, build the relationship, and solicit. Pledges were confirmed with a thank-you letter from the letter signer within 48 hours.

Program Goals

- Steward and renew donors, and re-engage lapsed donors
- Upgrade current donors and substantially increase average gifts
- Use multiple installment gifts to instill a habit of giving
- Gather feedback and update donor records
- Create a pipeline for major gifts

+39%
AVERAGE GIFT SIZE

MAIL + PHONE
THE COMBINATION THAT WON

WHY IT WORKED

- The client trained the callers personally
- Ask amounts came from real giving history
- Every pledge was confirmed within 48 hours

Catapult
FUNDRAISING

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